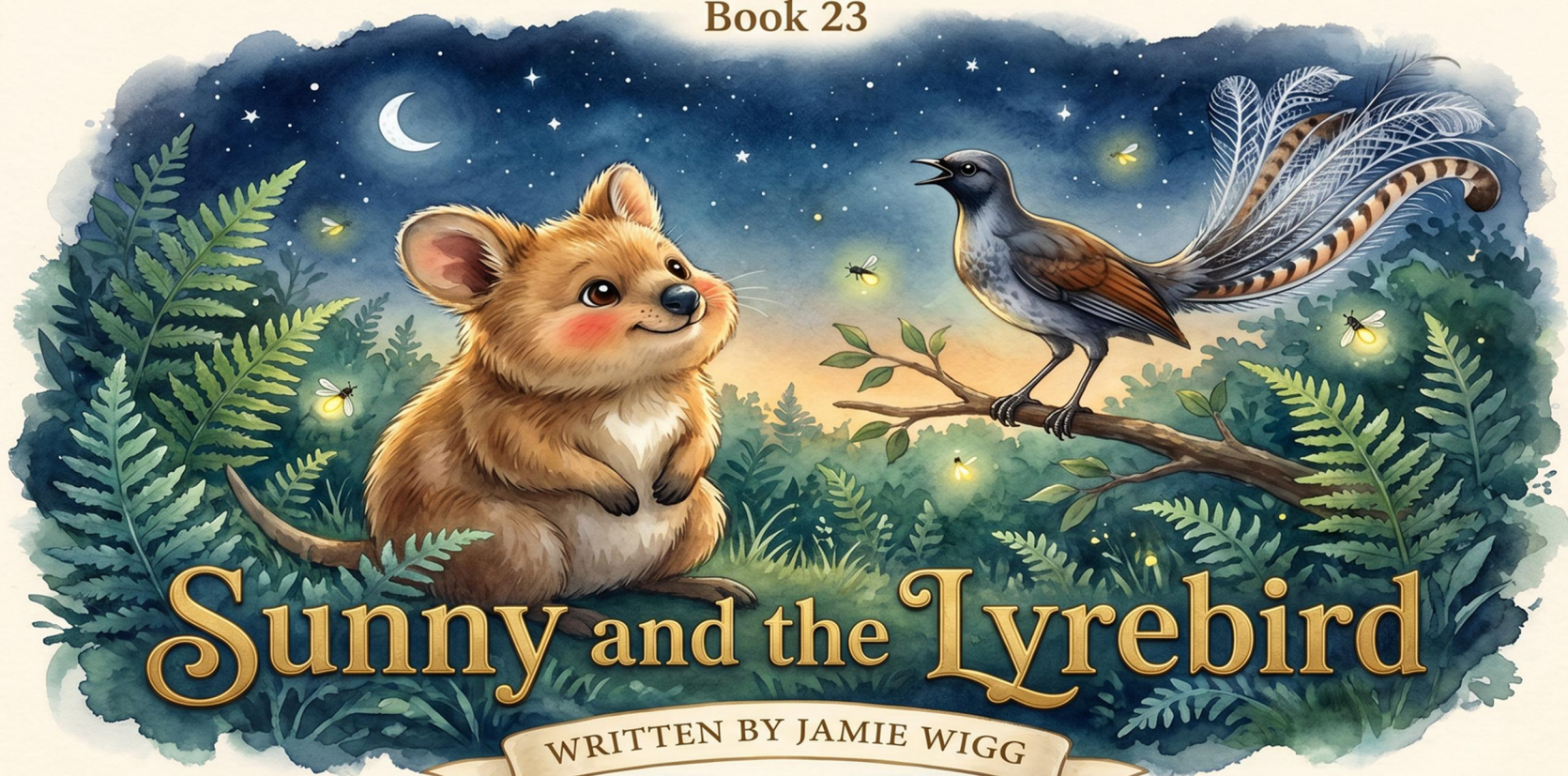


Sonny's Cozy Quokka Bedtime Tales

Book 23



WRITTEN BY JAMIE WIGG





Deep in the gully, ferns hung cool and green.
Sunny wandered soft through evening shade.



She heard the strangest, loveliest of songs —
a kookaburra, then a creek, then bells!



A lyrebird! With a tail like silver lace,
singing every sound the bush had taught him.



"Hello," said Sunny. "How do you know all the songs?"
"I listen all day long," he softly said.



"Would you like to hear the evening's song?"
And Sunny nodded, settling on the moss.



He sang the sound of raindrops on the leaves,
the whisper of the wind, the creek's soft laugh.



He sang the sleepy calls of all the birds,
each one saying goodnight across the bush.



The song grew slower, softer, like a wave
that rocks a little boat toward the shore.



At last he sang the quietest song of all:
the sound of falling stars and sleeping trees.



Then, bowing low, he folded up his tail,
and nestled in the ferns to take his rest.



Sunny lay upon her mossy bed,
the evening's song still playing in her heart.



The gully hushed. The ferns hung still and cool.
Everything was peaceful, deep, and safe.



Her eyes grew heavy as the echoes faded.
One slow blink... then another... then no more.



And Sunny slept inside the gully's song,
dreaming all the music of the bush.



Goodnight, Sunny. Goodnight, singing lyrebird.
Goodnight, sleepy gully. Goodnight, little one.

The End

Sweet dreams, little one.

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